

Lec 01 - Course Intro

COMPSCI 220 Section 01 - Perretta

Agenda

- Course overview & important policies
- Expectations & support
- New material: `map` & `filter`

Course Goals

Help you develop big-picture skills

- Write expressive, understandable, & maintainable code
- Test code effectively, build confidence that it's correct
- Understand language features across languages

TypeScript (TS) & JavaScript (JS)

We use TypeScript in this course, but this is **not a TypeScript course**

- Learn principles applicable to other languages
- Sometimes have to address concrete details of TypeScript
- Understand the **meaning** beneath the syntax

TypeScript code **compiles to JavaScript** after running a **type checker**.

Synchronization Between Sections

Prof. Minea and I are coordinating/sharing:

- Syllabus
- Topics & Assignments
- Exams
 - **Final Exam time is TBD. The default on spire will change once a combined time has been scheduled**
- TAs/UCAs/SI

For non-TA/UCA questions, talk to me, not Prof. Minea.

Office Hours

- TA/UCA office hours will be posted on the course website
 - <https://umass-compsci-220.github.io/>
- My office hours are **Tuesdays & Thursdays 2-3pm** in **LGRC A211E**

Course Tools

- Canvas: <https://umamherst.instructure.com/>
 - Lecture notes & slides, gradebook
- Course Website: <https://umass-compsci-220.github.io/>
 - Homework assignments, coding guidelines, tutorials, & other resources
- Gradescope: <https://www.gradescope.com/>
 - Submitting HW assignments
- Campuswire: <https://campuswire.com/>
 - Course communication, announcement, questions, etc.

Grade Components

- **Homework** (45%)
 - Your lowest homework score is dropped
- **Lab Participation** (8%)
 - In-lab quizzes/coding assignments
- **Lecture attendance/questions** (2%)
 - A good-faith attempt to answer the question will receive credit. Only your highest 20 scores will count towards grade.
- **Exams** (45%)
 - 2 midterms + final exam, 15% each
 - Dates & times in syllabus, locations TBA

Today's Attendance Question

Click on today's date at people.cs.umass.edu/~jperretta/cs220/f26/

You Belong in Computing

- You are welcome, regardless of previous computer science experience, age, citizenship, disability, sex, gender identity, military experience, political views, race, religion, or sexual orientation.
- We are committed to providing the same learning opportunities for all students. If you have a physical, psychological, or learning disability documented with Disability Services please communicate your needs as early as you can so we can make any necessary accommodations.
- We want to support you. Your place is here.

We Want to Help You Succeed

- We'll aim to explain things clearly (feedback is welcome!)
- We'll hold office hours
- And answer your posts on Campuswire
- We'll post copies of class slides and notes on Canvas
- We will make sure that every concept you need to know to complete homework and exams is discussed in class.
- We'll grade your assignments promptly
- All of your questions are valid and will be treated as such.

Expectations

- You are responsible for knowing ALL information contained in the syllabus
- Your code must compile and run
 - Code that does not work will not receive credit
- No late work will be accepted
 - See the syllabus for more information and exceptions
 - Homework deadlines are non-negotiable

Expectations

1. Start assignments early
2. Test your code thoroughly
3. Come to labs and office hours
4. Ask questions
5. Discuss concepts with each other
6. Apply the things we learn

Electronic Devices in Class

- Please use electronic devices only to engage with the material
 - e.g., taking notes, following along, completing activities
- If you find yourself using a device for something else, please put it away

Collaboration

Unless otherwise specified:

- Discussing concepts and general problem-solving & testing strategies is encouraged
- Looking at or copying other students' homework is **not allowed**
- All code you write **must be your own**
- Copying code from others, the internet, or AI helpers is **not allowed**

AI Use: Why We Don't Allow It

- We want you to develop **generalizable skills & expertise**
- Preliminary research suggests that improper AI use can hinder learning
- Even if AI tools are (hypothetically) 98% accurate, you need to be prepared to handle that 2%
- Learn how to program without them first, then learn to critically examine their output

Plagiarism Detection

- We will be using automated and manual means for detecting software plagiarism.
- Plagiarism is academic dishonesty and will be reported.
- If you plan to use Github or BitBucket etc. PLEASE make your repository private!
- When in doubt, contact the instructor about whether a potential action would be considered plagiarism.